



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Ambrose Academy
School Website: <https://ambroseacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: St. Ambrose Academy**

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school's public materials consistently foreground a Catholic theological vision (Mass, sacraments, chaplain), articulate formation in virtue and wisdom as the telos of education, and describe a liberal arts curriculum anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, primary sources, and Socratic pedagogy. Evidence includes explicit references to "Christ-filled community," "regular access to Mass and the Sacraments," "form the whole person in virtue," "primary sources," "Socratic teaching," and a course of study listing Latin, Logic, and Rhetoric by name. - School website used: <https://ambroseacademy.org/>

Method note: This audit applies the positive/negative keyword indicators and six-category framework from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the companion lexicon, comparing St. Ambrose's site language to confirm or negate classical identity across each category.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS - What we looked for (per "Six Elements" and lexicon): transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom), theological grounding (theology, faith and reason), liturgical and communal practices (liturgy, Mass, chapel, prayer). - Site keywords/evidence found: - "Christ-filled community"; "Catholic Faith"; "form the human person" - "Regular access to Mass and the Sacraments ... mentored by a chaplain ... deep love of Jesus Christ" - "Oratory for worship" at the new campus; "daily prayer" appears in school communications and events - "Truth" repeatedly connected to learning (e.g., Socratic leading to truth; Blessed Sacrament called "the ultimate primary source") - Keyword comparison to "Six Elements" positives: theology/Christ-centered, liturgy/-Mass/chapel/prayer, virtue/formation, truth—all strong matches. No "values-neutral" or "relativism" signals were found (negatives). - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 10 (Christ-filled, Catholic Faith, virtue, truth, Mass, Sacraments, chaplain, oratory/worship, prayer, Christ-centered) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage of sub-criteria (moral realism, theology, liturgy): 100% (3/3) - Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL - What we looked for: formation and the cultivation of wisdom/virtue (not mere job prep), pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, education as formation not information. - Site keywords/evidence found: - "Education ... good in itself," "form the whole person in virtue—intellectual, moral, and theological" - "Return to classical methodology ... to form the human person" - The "great conversation" and Western heritage orientation implied via "great ideas," integrated history sequence by era - Comparison: Matches the "wisdom/virtue," "formation," and "true/good/beautiful" thrust of the positive indicators. The site also mentions students being "well prepared for post-high school college study," which is acceptable but can echo a negative signal when it dominates; here, it does not dominate the mission framing. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 7 (formation, virtue, purpose beyond utility, truth, great conversation/Western heritage, integrated vision, human flourishing) - Negative hits: 2 (college-prep language appears but not dominant) - Percent positive: 78% - Coverage of sub-criteria: 100% (3/3) - Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM - What we looked for: the liberal arts (Trivium/Quadrivium), history as history (not "social studies"), Great Books/primary sources/Great Conversation, integrated studies/wonder. - Site keywords/evidence found: - Trivium explicitly named: "grammar, logic, and rhetoric" (tools and courses) - Course of study lists Latin, Logic, Rhetoric, Philosophy, History (by era), Religion across grades 6–12; no "social studies" labeling found - "Primary sources," "great ideas," students join a conversation

“taking place for millennia” (Great Books proxy language) - Comparison: Strong alignment with positive indicators (Trivium, Latin, Great Books via primary sources, integrated historical sequence). Occasional STEM language is framed as subordinate to and strengthened by the liberal arts (not a STEM-first orientation). - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 10 (Trivium terms x3, Latin, Logic, Rhetoric, Philosophy, primary sources, great ideas/great conversation, integrated history) - Negative hits: 1 (minor “hands-on experiments” mention—acceptable in moderation; not “project-based learning dominance”) - Percent positive: 91% - Coverage of sub-criteria: 75% (3/4; explicit “wonder” language not observed) - Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS - What we looked for: restful/colé learning, memory/chant in lower grades, Socratic discussion/dialectic in upper grades, rhetoric/speeches/orations opportunities. - Site keywords/evidence found: - “Socratic teaching ... ‘soul leading’ ... lead students to discover the truth,” distinction from open-ended seminars; multiple mentions of “discussion-based classroom” - Rhetoric in the junior year and a Senior Seminar named in the graduation sequence (rhetorical formation implied) - Comparison: Strong on Socratic/dialectic and rhetoric trajectory for 6–12. No explicit “scholé” or “restful learning” terminology found; memory/chant keywords are not advertised (the school begins at grade 6, where chant is less central). One mild experiential phrase (“hands-on experiments”) appears but is integrated within a classical framework, not as constructivist pedagogy dominance. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 3 (Socratic, discussion-based, rhetoric/Senior Seminar) - Negative hits: 1 (hands-on experiments—minor) - Percent positive: 75% - Coverage of sub-criteria: 50% (2/4; clear Socratic and rhetoric focus; no explicit scholé/memory/chant claims) - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY - What we looked for: teachers as models/mentors, collegial culture; “living curriculum,” portrait/profile of teacher/student. - Site keywords/evidence found: - “Role Models for the Next Generation,” “witnesses to a life-long love of learning,” and “collaborative and collegial work environment” for faculty - “Mentored by a chaplain and teachers,” emphasizing imitation of virtue; faculty/staff annually affirm a Profession of Faith (virtue/formation, faith and reason) - Comparison: Strong matches to positive indicators of teachers as virtuous mentors and collegial culture. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 5 (role models, mentorship, virtue modeling, collegiality, profession of faith) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage of sub-criteria: 100% (2/2) - Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY - What we looked for: partnership with parents as co-educators, parent formation, open campus/ongoing hospitality/community life. - Site keywords/evidence found: - Repeated open invitations to “Visit,” tours, and Open House classroom observations; robust community calendar (Benefit Dinner, community events) - Community life around feasts (e.g., All Saints’ Party), litany/bonfire, school-wide celebrations - History page stresses a “broader community of families” building a “culture of virtue” together - Comparison: Clear hospitality/community life and open-door culture; however, we found no explicit “parent as co-teacher/parent formation” language typical of K–8 hybrids. Evidence of partnership is present but not articulated as parent formation programming. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 4 (visits/open house, community calendar, feasts/events, community of families) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Coverage of sub-criteria: 33% (1/3 explicitly; events/hospitality are strong, but parent-formation/co-teaching not explicit) - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment - Strength of evidence across six elements: Robust and coherent. The school directly states it is a Catholic classical junior/senior high school; the curriculum and pedagogy align with classical hallmarks (Trivium, Latin, primary sources, Socratic method; rhetoric and senior-year seminar; integrated history). Religious and metaphysical foundations are especially strong, with Mass/sacramental life and a chaplain integrated into school life, matching liturgical/communal best practices in the “Six Elements” framework. Faculty culture and mentoring ethos are also explicitly emphasized. - Weaker signals: While grades 6–12 appropriately emphasize Socratic/rhetoric, published materials don’t highlight scholé/restful learning, or lower-school memory/chant (not applicable to K–5 since the school starts at grade 6). Parent partnership/formation could be made more explicit in public materials (though hospitality/community life is evident). - Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Citations to standards used in this audit: Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (positive/negative indicators and category definitions) and the classicality lexicon for keyword matching and interpretation.

Detailed Keyword Tally (by category) - Element 1 (Religious/Metaphysical): +10 / -0; 100% positive; 100% coverage (moral realism, theology, liturgy). - Element 2 (Purpose/Goal): +7 / -2; 78% positive; 100% coverage (virtue/wisdom, formation, transcendentals). - Element 3 (Curriculum): +10 / -1; 91% positive; 75% coverage (Trivium/Latin/Great Books proxies/integration; “wonder” not explicit). - Element 4 (Pedagogy): +3 / -1; 75% positive; 50% coverage (Socratic/rhetoric strong; scholé/memory not explicit). - Element 5 (Faculty): +5 / -0; 100% positive; 100% coverage (models/mentors; collegiality). - Element 6 (Parents/Community): +4 / -0; 100% positive; 33% coverage (hospitality/events strong; parent formation/co-teaching not explicit).

Notes tying school language to the “Six Elements” lexicon - Positive lexicon matches include truth, virtue, wisdom, theology/Christ-centered, liturgy/Mass/chapel, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Latin, Socratic/dialectic, great conversation/primary sources, integrated curriculum, and community life—all canonical classical signals in the lexicon and “Six Elements” document. - No dominant negative signals (e.g., values-neutral/relativism, social studies replacing history, project-based/constructivist dominance, STEM-first branding) were found; occasional “hands-on experiments” and “academic rigor” phrasing are contextually integrated rather than progressive replacements.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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